

Anyway, driving home after a surprisingly successful daddy day, I overhear the boys whispering to one another.

‘What’s going on?’ I ask.

‘Mummy buys us ice-cream when we’ve been good,’ says my oldest.

I’m being played, of course, but it’s a hot day and I feel like ice-cream myself, so we stop at the ice-cream shop.

‘How many scoops do you usually have?’ I naively ask my two-year-old.

‘Four’, he says, holding up three fingers.

Hmmm.

I study the pimply faced teenage ice-cream ‘artist’ for confirmation that this is indeed an acceptable serving size for a toddler. He simply shrugs his shoulders, heaps four mounds of creamy sugar into a bowl, douses it with thick syrupy chocolate, and pumps hundreds-and-thousands on top for good measure.

My two-year-old excitedly snatches the bowl out of my hands, while the ice-cream teen racks up another bowl for the five-year-old. After I pay, I notice that my younger one has already inhaled the ice-cream and is wearing his bowl as a hat.

Five minutes later, the sugar rush is coursing through their veins.

The two-year-old, now strapped into his car seat, is jerking uncontrollably, screaming a Wiggles song at the top of his lungs.

As we return home, they turn to each other and start fighting like WWE wrestlers.

My wife opens the door looking bloated and bothered, clutching her tummy like she’s attempting to stop the baby from dropping.

She takes one look at the boys and then glares at me.

Then the five-year-old dobs me in: ‘Daddy let us have four scoops of ice-cream!’

And then vomits on the carpet.